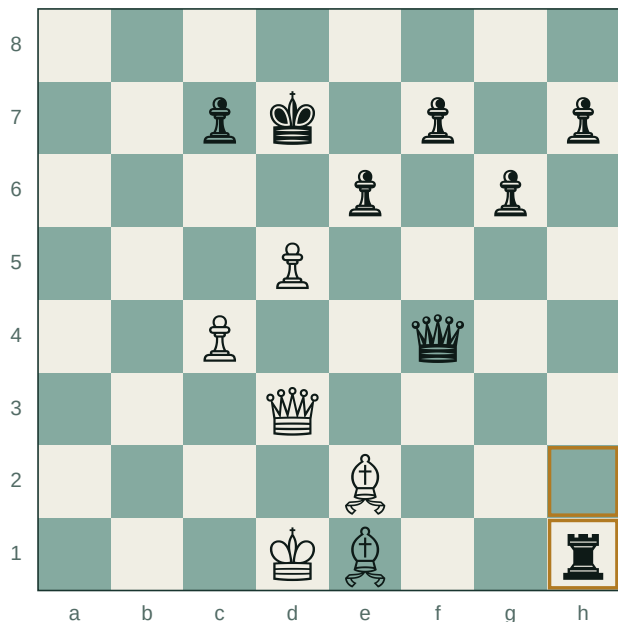


Double checks: White, move 40

Double checks

White to move



Previous move: 39...Rh1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

40. dxe6+ Kxe6 41. Qd5+ Ke7 42. Qxh1

40.dxe6+ Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. The changed line means the queen on d3 attacks the king on d7. Recorded reply: **40...Kxe6**.

41.Qd5+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From d5 it attacks king on e6 and rook on h1. Recorded reply: **41...Ke7**.

42.Qxh1 The queen captures the rook on h1.

At the end, nominal material is White 16 / Black 13 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -2 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Double check is forcing, but not necessarily winning. The king may escape to safety if the follow-up is missing.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Double check attacks the king with two pieces at once. The defender must move the king, so an ordinary block or capture of just one checker cannot solve the problem.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the slider that can be uncovered and a checking destination for its blocker. Then calculate the king's legal escapes.

The defending king is on d7. Geometrically undefended: queen on f4 and rook on h1. Check for tactical protection.